on the inside track. Also, my exposure to the Washington IMF and G20 meetings had given me a keener, if also a more disturbing, perception of the uncertainty and turmoil in the global economy and finance, an appreciation that differed from that of our external interlocutors.

Global Coordination and Consultation

There was no let-up in the financial market uncertainty and global economic convulsions up until December 2008. The international media ran saturated coverage of the crisis, and reams were being written on its diagnosis and prognosis; analysts were busy critiquing policy responses and offering their own advice on what should and should not be done by policymakers. This advice spanned a wide spectrum of issues—stabilizing the markets, arresting the economic downturn, coordinated fiscal stimulus, infusing capital into banks, disciplining shadow banks, punishing guilty banks and bankers, and international cooperation, just to name a few. As someone said, in an otherwise no-growth world, the only growth to be seen during this period was in the output by economists, analysts and financial sector commentators.

The crisis tested the leadership mettle of central bank governors. Even big-name governors were struggling to cope with the challenge of the biggest financial crisis since the Great Depression. For me, there was additional pressure as I was called upon to perform on the big stage even before I had time to establish my credentials and before the market had time to size me up. I was aware that the markets were struggling to interpret my actions and words. And what with all the speculation surrounding my appointment about whether I would act at the government's bidding, I also had to endure intense scrutiny for acting independently.

If advanced economy central banks were shaken by the ferocity and unpredictability of the crisis, for us in emerging markets, it was a double whammy since we had to factor in not only the uncertainty of the global market developments, but also the uncertainty of how the policy responses of advanced economies would impact our economies and our markets.